

Heuristic Analysis evaluates the product features and design according to Nielsen's well-established design principles. Again, follow this up with a Usability Test.

Deployment

After the product is launched, conduct Surveys of your users and do additional Field Studies to gauge the real-world usage of your product. If any mistakes in the design of the User Experience become apparent, revisit the previous phase and remake the final product. You can also use analytics tools to get quantitative data on your product usage. Once again, do a Usability Test to check if the product fulfills all the Usability Objectives from the Analysis Phase. You can never do enough Usability Tests. Remember, the product is forever 'almost' finished.

Software Development Methodologies

Any industry, being large scale, must be appropriately managed to ensure there is no compromise or variance in quality. That is why we have industry standards. They provide a framework for creating products consistently and reliably. Before the software industry grew to its current size, in fact, before the seed even sprouted, there was the hardware industry. Along with the hardware industry, there were its standards. When the software started booming into a full-fledged industry, they just adapted and adopted the standards of the hardware industry. Of course, this changed over time as industry processes evolved, but let us not get ahead of ourselves. The standards are defined by various phases or stages of development, and expected outcomes or criteria that define the beginning and ends of the various stages. The standards for creating software are in general known as Software Development Processes, which are considered to be a subset of the Systems Development Life-Cycle.

Waterfall

Waterfall development is named so because of the linear flow of water in a waterfall. This methodology has clearly demarcated phases and the process always and only flows from one stage to the next, in a linear fashion. It is considered the more 'traditional' approach, probably owing to its similarities to hardware standards. It was also promoted by the United States Department of Defense in their publication of project standards, DOD-STD-2167A in 1988. The different activities are popularly categorized as : Require-